



ServiceNow Hosted Instance API Security Incident — Threat Intelligence Executive Summary

Executive Summary

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IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and

validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

Table of Contents

- [1. BLUF](#)
- [2. Expected Impact Statement](#)
- [3. What Happened](#)
- [4. Why It Matters](#)

- [5. Confidence and Caveats](#)
- [6. Immediate Actions for Defenders](#)
- [7. Bottom-Line Assessment](#)

1. BLUF

Between 2-3 June 2026, attackers exploited a ServiceNow-hosted API access control failure to query data from a subset of customer instances before the vendor pushed a hosted fix on 5 June. Public reporting and multiple secondary sources consistently indicate the exposure was tied to an endpoint associated with `/api/now/related_list_edit/create` and a configuration state that allowed unauthenticated access. The most material enterprise risk is not only the direct exposure of tickets, employee records, workflow data, and security cases, but the secondary exposure of credentials, API tokens, integration secrets, and internal process knowledge commonly stored in ServiceNow records.

2. Expected Impact Statement

Expected impact is HIGH for directly affected tenants and MODERATE for the broader ServiceNow customer base. For affected organisations, likely consequences include regulatory notification pressure, third-party risk escalation, targeted follow-on intrusion using harvested secrets, and trust degradation around SaaS control boundaries. For customers not individually notified by ServiceNow, immediate platform compromise risk appears reduced after the 5 June hosted remediation, but log review, secret rotation for sensitive records, and validation of legacy/custom API exposure remain warranted.

3. What Happened

- ServiceNow applied a hosted security update on 5 June 2026 after identifying a security issue that could let an unauthenticated user gain greater access to instances than intended.
- The vendor stated that, for a subset of customers, it observed successful queries of instance tables and notified those customers directly by support case.
- Public reporting indicates the issue primarily impacted Australia-release tenants and some earlier-release instances with specific configuration changes.
- Community and third-party reporting strongly suggest the issue involved `/api/now/related_list_edit/create` and missing authentication on a Scripted REST resource.

4. Why It Matters

- ServiceNow often stores highly sensitive operational data rather than just ticket metadata.
- Support cases and attachments can contain credentials, API tokens, architecture notes, and troubleshooting artefacts that enable follow-on intrusion.

- Even a limited read-only exposure can materially increase phishing, identity-abuse, and vendor-impersonation risk.
- Notification timing and hidden-advisory handling create third-party risk and compliance questions for affected organisations.

5. Confidence and Caveats

Category	Assessment
High confidence	Hosted remediation date, successful table queries for a subset of customers, vendor notification-by-case model, affected-scope language, and no public CVE assignment as of publication.
Medium confidence	Exact endpoint path, requires_authentication=false root-cause theory, Guest log context, and IP 51.159.98.241 as a primary hunt lead.
Low-to-medium confidence	Additional IP 86.245.155.105 and the claim that the issue was internally documented on 7 April 2026.

6. Immediate Actions for Defenders

- Confirm whether your organisation received a ServiceNow support case tied to the incident.
- Review ServiceNow transaction and node logs for 2-3 June 2026, with focus on /api/now/related_list_edit/create and Guest-context activity.
- Review tickets, attachments, and knowledge records that may have contained plaintext credentials or sensitive implementation detail.
- Rotate any exposed secrets and monitor for follow-on use across identity, VPN, cloud, and developer platforms.
- Audit custom and legacy Scripted REST Resources for both authentication and ACL enforcement.

7. Bottom-Line Assessment

This incident should be treated as a confirmed third-party SaaS security event with likely downstream exploitation value. Even if the exposed dataset proves limited, ServiceNow commonly holds the exact operational detail adversaries need to pivot into broader enterprise compromise.